

Preventing & Recovering from Workplace Burnout

What Is Burnout?

Burnout is a state of chronic stress that leads to physical and emotional exhaustion, cynicism and detachment, and feelings of ineffectiveness. Unlike regular tiredness, burnout does not resolve with a single good night of sleep. The World Health Organization classifies burnout as an occupational phenomenon. Early recognition is key to prevention.

Warning Signs

Common signs of burnout include: constant fatigue even after rest, reduced performance and concentration, increased cynicism about work, frequent headaches or muscle pain, withdrawing from responsibilities, and feelings of failure or self-doubt. If you recognize 3 or more of these signs, take action early.

What to Do If You Feel Burned Out

Step 1: Talk to your manager or HR - this is a safe conversation. Step 2: Use your mental health days or apply for a short leave. Step 3: Contact the EAP for professional counseling. Step 4: Review your workload with your manager to identify what can be delegated or deprioritized. Step 5: Attend our bi-weekly 'Recharge' virtual sessions run by our wellness team.

Manager's Role in Prevention

Managers should actively monitor workload distribution across their team. One-on-one meetings should include a wellness check-in, not just status updates. Encourage employees to take their full PTO and disconnect on weekends. Praise effort and progress, not just results. Avoid sending messages on weekends unless it is a genuine emergency.

Organizational Commitments

We conduct quarterly workload reviews across all teams. Headcount gaps are addressed within 60 days. No-meeting Fridays are enforced company-wide from 12 PM onward. Annual 'Unplugged Week' allows all employees to disconnect fully. AI tools are provided to automate repetitive tasks and reduce cognitive load.

Resources Available

Meditation app subscription (Calm or Headspace) - free for all employees. Weekly virtual yoga/fitness classes on Tuesdays and Thursdays at 6 PM. On-demand mental health webinars in the Learning Portal. Peer support circles run every other Friday - join via the Wellness Slack channel.